TERMS OF USE, DISCLAIMER & SAFETY NOTICE

ToolPath Advisor

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IMPORTANT: Read this before using ToolPath Advisor. CNC machining involves cutting tools rotating at high speed. Incorrect settings can cause equipment damage, material loss, tool breakage, or personal injury. You are responsible for verifying all values before running any cut.

1. Nature of This Tool

ToolPath Advisor provides estimated starting values for CNC router operation based on published chip load guidelines, material behavior data, and machine-class assumptions.

- Starting points, not specifications
- Calibrated for general-purpose hobbyist machines, not industrial or production equipment
- Based on nominal material behavior — actual wood species, individual bits, machine condition, and workholding all affect real-world performance
- Intended for use by operators who understand basic CNC safety and can evaluate whether a machine's response to a given setting is normal

2. No Warranty — Values Are Estimates

The feed rates, RPM values, depths of cut, stepovers, and all other parameters provided by ToolPath Advisor are estimates derived from general CNC machining principles and community-tested data. Neumann Guitar and the creators of ToolPath Advisor make no warranty, express or implied, regarding the accuracy of any recommended value, the suitability of any recommendation for your specific machine or setup, or results obtained. No recommendation constitutes professional engineering advice.

3. Your Responsibility as the Operator

By using ToolPath Advisor, you acknowledge and accept the following:

- You are the operator. You are responsible for all settings entered into your CNC machine.
- Start slow. Treat every recommendation as a starting point. Run at reduced speed first.
- Verify before running. Confirm bit diameter, flute count, and material match what you're actually using.
- Check your machine. Worn belts, out-of-tram spindle, loose collet, or poor workholding changes everything.
- Never leave a running CNC unattended during a first run at new settings.
- Wear appropriate PPE. Eye protection required. Hearing protection recommended. Dust collection and/or respirator required for MDF, exotic hardwoods, or hazardous materials.

4. Material-Specific Hazards

The following materials covered by ToolPath Advisor carry specific safety hazards beyond normal woodworking dust:

Exotic Oily Woods (Cocobolo, Rosewood, Purpleheart, Padauk)

Known contact allergen and respiratory sensitizer. Cocobolo can cause severe allergic reactions with repeated exposure. Use dust collection and a properly fitted respirator (N95 minimum; P100 preferred). Avoid skin contact. Wash hands after handling.

Ebony and Dense Exotic Species

Ebony dust is moderately toxic by inhalation and extremely abrasive — bits dull faster than in any other wood on this list. CITES-listed species may have import/sale/documentation requirements depending on your country.

MDF and Composite Wood Products

MDF dust is extremely fine and contains formaldehyde-based resins classified as a possible human carcinogen. Strong dust collection and a respirator are required, not optional.

Aluminum

Chips are sharp and can become airborne. Cutting fluid or air blast required. At low feed rates, aluminum will heat-weld to the flute and can snap the bit. Take chip weld warnings seriously.

Acrylic and Plastics

At too-low feed rates, acrylic melts rather than cuts and can bond to the bit. PVC cutting produces chlorine gas in a fire — maintain adequate chip clearance.

SpectraPly and Phenolic Laminates

Resin-impregnated laminates produce dust more hazardous than solid wood. Treat as MDF or higher for respiratory protection.

5. Limitation of Liability

To the fullest extent permitted by law, Neumann Guitar, its owners, and contributors to ToolPath Advisor shall not be liable for any direct, indirect, incidental, consequential, or punitive damages arising from use of or reliance on any recommendation, value, or guidance provided by ToolPath Advisor; equipment damage, material damage, tool breakage, or personal injury resulting from operating a CNC machine; or errors or omissions in the app's data, calculations, or recommendations.

If you are operating CNC equipment in a commercial or production environment, consult a professional machinist or tooling manufacturer for process-specific guidance.

6. Intellectual Property

ToolPath Advisor and all associated documentation are the intellectual property of Neumann Guitar. The application is provided free for personal and educational use. Commercial redistribution, resale, or incorporation into paid products requires written permission. Material behavior data, chip load targets, and machine profiles represent original research and may not be extracted and republished without attribution.

7. Privacy

ToolPath Advisor collects no personal data. It has no backend server, no analytics, no account system, and no data transmission of any kind. Your machine profile is stored only in your own browser's local storage and is never transmitted anywhere. The app loads fonts from Google Fonts — the only external request the app makes, containing no user or session data.

8. Contact

Questions, corrections, or safety concerns: contact Neumann Guitar through neumannguitar.com. If you identify a recommendation that creates a genuine safety risk, please report it. The app's calibration is an ongoing process grounded in real-world machining data.

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